Existence and Smoothness of Elementary Weak Solutions of the Navier–Stokes Equations: Elementary Partial Differential Equations Theory

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Abstract

We construct solutions depending on external forces and not on prescribed initial values. Our solutions are unique, smooth, analytic, and time global for small data. The method is similar to the Banach fixed-point theorem, but we do not assume that the image of the domain is contained in the domain itself.

1 Introduction

The existence of solutions is actually known. For example, there are the Fujita–Kato theory and the Shibata theory; see Kato [4], Zhang [12], Charve–Danchin [2], and Shibata–Murata [6].

Semigroup theory or a priori estimates appear in these theories, but they are not elementary. Semigroup theory or a priori estimates for contraction mappings are not used in the proof of the existence of Leray–Hopf weak solutions, for example in Shibagaki–Rikimaru [7], but those arguments are not elementary either.

We define new weak solutions with uniqueness and smoothness without using semigroup theory or a priori estimates. We apply the local solvability of linear partial differential operators with constant coefficients. The basic policy is to take

$$L = \partial_t - \Delta$$

as the heat operator in the initial value problem for the Navier–Stokes equations

$$\partial_t u - \Delta u = f - \nabla p - (u \cdot \nabla)u, \tag{N-S}$$

$$\operatorname{div} u = 0, \tag{σ}$$

$$u(0,x) = a(x), \tag{A}$$

together with the decay property

$$\lim_{t,\,|x|\to\infty} \partial^\alpha u(t,x) = 0, \tag{S}$$

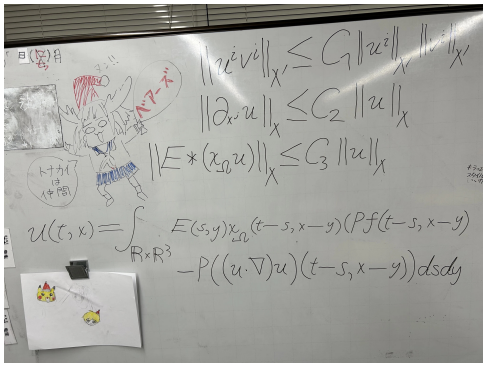
and continuity of the maps

$$f \longmapsto u, \qquad a \longmapsto u. \tag{C}$$

The uniqueness follows without imposing boundary conditions for u. Our solutions decrease rapidly, satisfy an energy inequality, and are analytic. We do not use long or complicated calculations, semigroup theory, a priori estimates, or a theory of evolution equations.

We apply the local solvability of linear partial differential operators with constant coefficients [3, 8], eliminate the pressure by the Helmholtz projection P, and solve

$$\partial_t u - \Delta u = Pf - P\big((u_n \cdot \nabla)u_n\big),$$
$$\partial_t u - \Delta u = Pf - P\big((u \cdot \nabla)u\big)$$



in a Sobolev-type space constructed below.

Let

$$\Omega \subset \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3$$

be a bounded domain with Lipschitz boundary such that

$$(0,0) \in \Omega.$$

A typical example is the cylinder

$$\Omega = I \times \Omega' = (-T, T) \times B_3(0, R).$$

We handle the variables t, x simultaneously. Cylinder domains are Lipschitz domains, so the Sobolev embedding theorem can be used on Ω, and the Helmholtz decomposition can be used on the spatial domain Ω'.

1 Definition

For convenience, the index of a component of a vector is written as an upper index. The words "function space" and "space" mean linear topological spaces of functions or distributions. Except for the pressure p, functions are $\mathbb{R}^3$-valued unless otherwise stated. We use the same symbols for spaces of real-valued and $\mathbb{R}^3$-valued functions when no confusion occurs.

Let $|\Omega|$ be the Lebesgue measure of Ω, and let χ_Ω denote the characteristic function of Ω. For

$$m > \max\left\{\frac{4}{1}, \frac{4}{2}\right\} = 4, \qquad p = 1, 2,$$

define

$$V^{m,p}(\Omega) = \left\{u = (u^1, u^2, u^3) : u^i \in C^\infty(\Omega),\ \|u^i\|_{W^{m,p}(\Omega)} < \infty\right\},$$

and

$$V^{m,p}_\sigma(\Omega) = \left\{u \in V^{m,p}(\Omega) : \operatorname{div} u = 0\right\}.$$

Let $W^{m,p}(\Omega)$ and $W^{m,p}_\sigma(\Omega)$ be the Sobolev spaces obtained as the completions of these spaces.

Let $\mathcal{D}(\Omega) = C_0^\infty(\Omega)$, and let

$$\mathcal{D}_\sigma(\Omega) = \left\{\varphi \in \mathcal{D}(\Omega)^3 : \operatorname{div}_x \varphi = 0\right\}.$$

Let

$$P : X' \longrightarrow X$$

be the Helmholtz projection.

For vector fields w, φ, put

$$\begin{aligned}\langle w, \varphi\rangle = (w, \varphi)_{L^2(\Omega)} &= \int_\Omega w(t,x) \cdot \varphi(t,x)\, dt\, dx \\ &= \int_\Omega \sum_{i=1}^3 w^i(t,x)\varphi^i(t,x)\, dt\, dx.\end{aligned}$$

If X, Y are Banach spaces continuously contained in a Hausdorff linear space Z, then $X \cap Y$ is a Banach space with either of the equivalent norms

$$\|u\|_X + \|u\|_Y, \qquad \max\{\|u\|_X, \|u\|_Y\}.$$

Indeed,

$$\max\{\|u\|_X, \|u\|_Y\} \le \|u\|_X + \|u\|_Y \le 2\max\{\|u\|_X, \|u\|_Y\}.$$

Put

$$\mathcal{X}_\sigma = \bigcap_{m \ge 5} \left(W^{m,1}_\sigma(\Omega) \cap W^{m,2}_\sigma(\Omega)\right).$$

and

$$\mathcal{X}' = \bigcap_{m\geq 5} \left(W^{m,1}(\Omega) \cap W^{m,2}(\Omega)\right).$$

For suitable positive constants $c'_{k,m} \geq c_m^{-1/2}$ (See [19]), define

$$\|u\|_X = \sum_{m=5}^{\infty}\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(m!)^4 (c'_{k,m})^2} \|u\|_{W^{m,1}(\Omega)\cap W^{m,2}(\Omega)}$$

for $u \in \mathcal{X}_\sigma$, and similarly

$$\|u\|_{X'} = \sum_{m=5}^{\infty}\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(m!)^4 (c'_{k,m})^2} \|u\|_{W^{m,1}(\Omega)\cap W^{m,2}(\Omega)}$$

for $u \in \mathcal{X}'$. If $c'_{k,m}$ does not depend on k, we do not sum with respect to k.

Then put

$$X = \{u \in \mathcal{X}_\sigma : \|u\|_X < \infty\}, \qquad X' = \{u \in \mathcal{X}' : \|u\|_{X'} < \infty\}.$$

For constants $M, C > 0$, define

$$S = \left\{u \in X : \ \|u\|_X \leq M, \ \|\partial^\alpha u\|_X \leq C^{|\alpha|}\|u\|_X \text{ for all } \alpha\right\}.$$

Let E be the fundamental solution of the heat operator

$$\partial_t - \Delta.$$

Thus

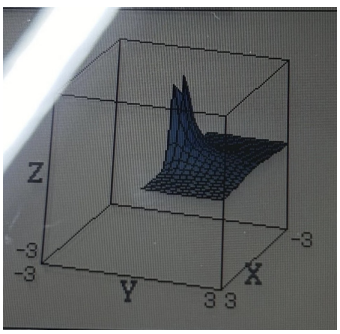
$$(\partial_t - \Delta)E = \delta(t) \otimes \delta(x)$$

in the sense of distributions, where

$$E(t,x) = \begin{cases} \dfrac{1}{(4\pi t)^{3/2}} \exp\left(-\dfrac{|x|^2}{4t}\right), & t > 0, \\ 0, & t \leq 0. \end{cases}$$

3 Existence of elementary weak solutions

Assumption



Let

$$\Omega \subset \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3$$

be a bounded domain with Lipschitz boundary and

$$(0,0) \in \Omega.$$

Let

$$f : \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3 \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$$

be an external force such that

$$Pf \in S.$$

If $f \neq 0$, assume further that there exists $(0,x) \in \Omega$ such that

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3} E(s,y)(\chi_\Omega Pf)(-s, x-y)\, ds\, dy \neq 0.$$

Let A denote the set of initial values

$$A = \left\{u(0,\cdot) : u \in X, \quad u(t,x) = \int_{\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3} E(s,y)\big(\chi_\Omega P(f - (u\cdot\nabla)u)\big)(t-s, x-y)\, ds\, dy\right\}.$$

Proposition 3.1 (Local solvability of linear partial differential operators with constant coefficients)**.** *Let L be a linear partial differential operator with constant coefficients on $\mathbb{R}^N$, and let $E \in \mathcal{D}'(\mathbb{R}^N)$ be a fundamental solution:*

$$LE = \delta.$$

For $f \in L^1_{\mathrm{loc}}(\mathbb{R}^N)$ and a bounded domain $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^N$, a weak solution of

$$Lu = f \quad \text{in } \Omega$$

is given by

$$u = E * (\chi_\Omega f) \in \mathcal{D}'(\Omega).$$

Proof. For every $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}(\Omega)$,

$$\begin{aligned}
\langle L(E * (\chi_\Omega f)), \varphi \rangle &= \pm \langle E * (\chi_\Omega f), L\varphi \rangle \\
&= \pm \langle E(x), \langle \chi_\Omega(y) f(y), L\varphi(x+y) \rangle \rangle \\
&= \pm \langle \chi_\Omega(x) f(x), \langle E(y), L\varphi(x+y) \rangle \rangle \\
&= \langle \chi_\Omega(x) f(x), \langle LE(y), \varphi(x+y) \rangle \rangle \\
&= \langle f, \varphi \rangle .
\end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 3.2 (Main theorem). *The set A is nonempty. For every $a \in A$, there exist elementary weak solutions u, p of*

$$\partial_t u - \Delta u = f - \nabla p - (u \cdot \nabla) u, \qquad \operatorname{div} u = 0, \qquad u(0, x) = a(x)$$

in Ω, in the sense that

$$u \in X, \qquad p \in L^2_{\mathrm{loc}}(\Omega)/(p \sim q :\iff \nabla(p - q) = 0),$$

and

$$\langle \partial_t u + (u \cdot \nabla) u - \Delta u + \nabla p - f, \varphi \rangle = 0$$

for every $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}_\sigma(\Omega)$, while

$$\langle \operatorname{div} u, \varphi \rangle = -\sum_{j=1}^{3} \langle u^j, \partial_{x^j} \varphi \rangle = 0$$

for every $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}(\Omega)$. For every multi-index $\alpha \in \mathbb{Z}^4_{\geq 0}$,

$$\lim_{t,\, |x| \to \infty} \partial^\alpha u(t, x) = 0.$$

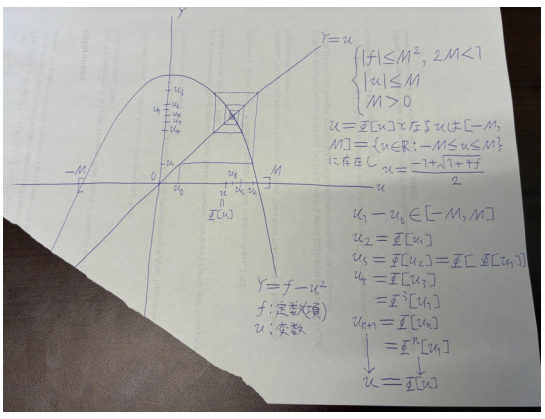
If two solutions u, p and v, q satisfy

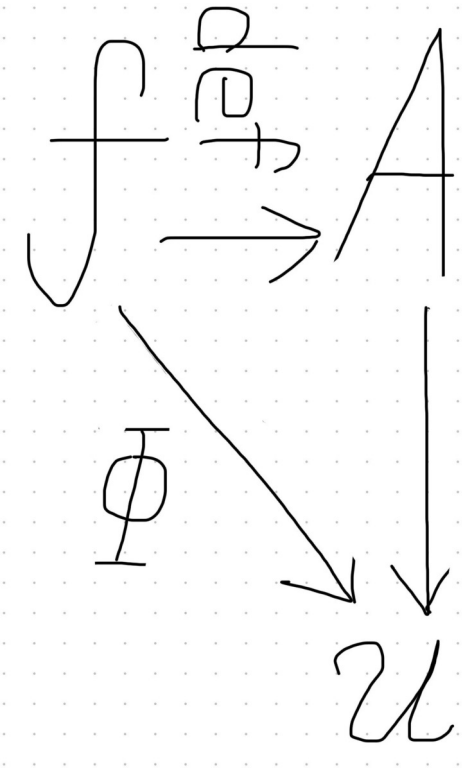
$$u, v \in S, \qquad u - v \in S,$$

then

$$u = v, \qquad p = q$$

on Ω. The map $f \mapsto u$ is continuous.





Proposition 3.3 (Smoothness of elementary weak solutions)**.** *The elementary weak solutions* (u, p) *are* C^∞*-functions.*

Proof. Since $m \in \mathbb{N}$ may be taken arbitrarily large, the Sobolev embedding theorem gives, whenever

$$N < m - \frac{4}{p},$$

a continuous embedding

$$W^{m,p}(\Omega) \hookrightarrow C^{N,\alpha}(\Omega), \qquad 0 < \alpha < 1.$$

Hence u has a C^∞-representative. Since

$$\partial_t u + (u \cdot \nabla)u - \Delta u - f = -\nabla p$$

is smooth, p is smooth as well. □

Lemma 3.4. *The normed spaces* X *and* X' *are nontrivial.*

Proof. It is enough to exhibit nonzero elements. For example, suitable restrictions of

$$\operatorname{curl}(e^{x_1}, e^{x_3}, e^{x_2})$$

belong to the divergence-free class, while functions such as

$$e^{x_1}, \qquad \sin x_2$$

give nonzero elements of the corresponding scalar spaces. Thus

$$X \neq \{0\}, \qquad X' \neq \{0\}.$$

□

Lemma 3.5 (Completeness)**.** *The spaces* X *and* X' *are Banach spaces.*

Proof. Let $\{u_n\}$ be a Cauchy sequence in X. Then it is Cauchy in every

$$W^{m,1}_\sigma(\Omega) \cap W^{m,2}_\sigma(\Omega).$$

Since these are Banach spaces, u_n converges in each of them to a common limit u. For every $\varepsilon > 0$, there is N such that for $l, n \geq N$,

$$\|u_l - u_n\|_X < \varepsilon.$$

By Fatou's lemma for counting measure,

$$\begin{aligned}
\|u - u_n\|_X &= \sum_{m=5}^{\infty} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(m!)^4 (c'_{k,m})^2} \|u - u_n\|_{W^{m,1} \cap W^{m,2}} \\
&\leq \liminf_{l \to \infty} \sum_{m=5}^{\infty} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(m!)^4 (c'_{k,m})^2} \|u_l - u_n\|_{W^{m,1} \cap W^{m,2}} \\
&\leq \varepsilon.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$\|u\|_X \leq \|u - u_N\|_X + \|u_N\|_X < \infty,$$

and $u \in X$. The proof for X' is identical. □

Lemma 3.6 (Separation of product). *There exists a constant $C_1 > 0$ such that*

$$\|u^i v^i\|_{X'} \le C_1 \|u^i\|_{X'} \|v^i\|_{X'}$$

for all $u, v \in X'$.

Proof. For multi-indices $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{Z}^4_{\ge 0}$, let $c_{\alpha,\beta}$ denote the binomial coefficients appearing in the Leibniz formula, and set

$$c_\alpha = \sum_{\beta \le \alpha} c_{\alpha,\beta}.$$

There is a continuous embedding

$$X' \hookrightarrow C^{k,\gamma}(\Omega)$$

for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, $0 < \gamma < 1$. Thus, for suitable constants $c'_{k,m} > 0$,

$$\|u\|_{C^{k,\gamma}(\Omega)} \le c'_{k,m} \|u\|_{X'}.$$

By Leibniz' formula,

$$\begin{aligned} \|\partial^\alpha (uv)\|_{L^p(\Omega)} &\le c_\alpha \|u\|_{C^{k,\gamma}(\Omega)} \|v\|_{C^{k,\gamma}(\Omega)} |\Omega|^{1/p} \\ &\le c_\alpha (c'_{k,m})^2 |\Omega|^{1/p} \|u\|_{X'} \|v\|_{X'}, \qquad |\alpha| \le k. \end{aligned}$$

Hence, there is $C'_1 > 0$ such that

$$\|uv\|_{X',\mathrm{new}} \le C'_1 \|u\|_{X',\mathrm{old}} \|v\|_{X',\mathrm{old}}.$$

From the proof of the Sobolev embedding theorem (See [19]), one may choose a constant C_4 independent on k so that, for every $\omega \Subset \Omega$, $\rho \in \mathcal{D}(\Omega)$, $\rho|_\omega = 1$,

$$\|\rho u\|_{C^k(\Omega)} \le \|\rho u\|_{C^k(\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3)} \le C_4 \|\rho u\|_{W^{m,2}(\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3)} \le \frac{C_4}{\displaystyle\sum_{m\ge 5}\sum_{k\ge 0} \frac{1}{(m!)^4 (c'_{k,m})^2}} \|u\|_X.$$

Since ρ may be chosen arbitrarily, the corresponding constants $c''_{k,m}$ can be taken uniformly.

To compare the two norms, choose positive constants satisfying

$$c'_{k,m} \ge 1, \qquad c''_{k,m} \ge c'_{k,m},$$

and a family

$$0 < \rho_{k,m} \le 1$$

such that

$$\rho_{0,5} < \rho_{k+1,m+1} \le \rho_{k,m},$$

and

$$0 < \frac{\rho_{k,m}}{(c'_{k,m})^2} \le \frac{1}{(c''_{k,m})^2}.$$

Then the two resulting norms are equivalent. Consequently, there exists $0 < \rho < 1$ such that

$$\rho \|uv\|_{X',\mathrm{old}} \le \|uv\|_{X',\mathrm{new}} \le C'_1 \|u\|_{X',\mathrm{old}} \|v\|_{X',\mathrm{old}}.$$

Taking

$$C_1 = \frac{C'_1}{\rho}$$

gives the assertion. □

Lemma 3.7 (Absorption of differential). *There exists $C_2 > 0$ such that*

$$\|\partial_{x^j} u\|_X \le C_2 \|u\|_X$$

for every $u \in S$ and $j = 1, 2, 3$.

Lemma 3.8 (Convolution estimate). *There exists $C_3 > 0$ such that, for every*

$$u \in S \setminus \{v \in S : \partial^\alpha v = 0 \text{ for some } \alpha\},$$

one has

$$E * (\chi_\Omega u) \in X, \qquad \|E * (\chi_\Omega u)\|_X \le C_3 \|u\|_X,$$

together with

$$\|E * (\chi_\Omega \partial_{x^j} u)\|_X \le C_3 C_2 \|u\|_X.$$

Proof. We first specify why an extension is introduced and which parts of the argument require additional hypotheses. The convolution only uses the values of u inside Ω. An extension $\widetilde{u}$ of u may be assigned arbitrary values on Ω^c. Changes on null sets do not alter Lebesgue integrals. Since $u \in C^\infty(\Omega)$, all ordinary derivatives of u exist and are continuous at every point of Ω. We use these classical derivatives throughout. No derivative of χ_Ω is taken.

For each fixed $(t, x) \in \Omega$, the translation $(s, y) \mapsto (t - s, x - y)$ maps $-\Omega + (t, x)$ onto Ω. Consequently, $(s, y) \mapsto u(t - s, x - y)$ is smooth on $-\Omega + (t, x)$, and

$$\partial^\alpha_{s,y} u(t - s, x - y) = (-1)^{|\alpha|} (\partial^\alpha u)(t - s, x - y).$$

The convolution is therefore written as

$$(E * (\chi_\Omega u))(t, x) = \int_{-\Omega+(t,x)} E(s, y) u(t - s, x - y)\, ds\, dy. \tag{3.8a}$$

We now derive an integrable majorant needed for differentiation under the integral sign. Fix (s, y) and a multi-index α. Since $E(s, y)$ is independent of (t, x) and u is smooth on Ω, we have

$$\partial^\alpha_{t,x}[E(s, y)u(t - s, x - y)] = E(s, y)(\partial^\alpha_{t,x} u)(t - s, x - y).$$

Taking absolute values and bounding the derivative of u on Ω gives

$$\left|\partial^\alpha_{t,x}[E(s, y)u(t - s, x - y)]\right| \le |E(s, y)| \sup_{(t,x)\in\Omega} \left|\partial^\alpha_{t,x} u(t, x)\right|,$$

whenever $(t-s, x-y) \in \Omega$. Since u belongs to Hölder spaces of every order, $\sup_{(t,x)\in\Omega} |\partial^\alpha u(t, x)| < \infty$ for every multi-index α. Moreover, $E \in L^1(-\Omega + (t, x))$; hence the displayed majorant is integrable on $-\Omega + (t, x)$. This estimate controls the interior integrand; it does not, by itself, control the change of the integration domain as (t, x) varies.

The domain $-\Omega + (t, x)$ is a translate of the bounded domain Ω. The integral in (3.8a) is unchanged by modifying $\widetilde{u}$ outside Ω, since $(t - s, x - y) \in \Omega$ on this domain.

Fixing the integration domain. In order to apply integration by parts with a fixed inner integration domain, one would replace $-\Omega + (t, x)$ by Ω ; this step requires the identity

$$\int_{-\Omega+(t,x)} E(s, y)u(t-s, x-y)\, ds\, dy = \int_\Omega E(s, y)\widetilde{u}(t-s, x-y)\, ds\, dy \quad \text{for a.e. } (t, x) \in \Omega. \tag{3.8b}$$

This identity is not a consequence of freedom to choose values outside Ω alone: on the overlap the values are already fixed, and the portions of the two domains need not have equal contributions. Accordingly, (3.8b) is an explicit condition to be verified for the chosen extension.

Integration by parts. Let $\varphi \in C_0^\infty(\Omega)$. Whenever (3.8b) holds and the indicated integrals are absolutely integrable, Fubini's theorem and integration by parts give the following *conditional* calculation:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_\Omega \partial^\alpha (E * (\chi_\Omega u))(t,x)\varphi(t,x)\,dt\,dx &= (-1)^{|\alpha|}\int_\Omega (E * (\chi_\Omega u))(t,x)\partial^\alpha\varphi(t,x)\,dt\,dx \\ &= (-1)^{|\alpha|}\int_\Omega\int_\Omega E(s,y)\widetilde{u}(t-s,x-y)\partial^\alpha\varphi(t,x)\,ds\,dy\,dt\,dx \\ &= \int_\Omega\int_\Omega E(s,y)\partial^\alpha\widetilde{u}(t-s,x-y)\varphi(t,x)\,ds\,dy\,dt\,dx.\end{aligned}$$

For clarity, the final equality is an integration-by-parts identity in (t,x), with (s,y) fixed. It requires that $(t,x) \mapsto \widetilde{u}(t-s,x-y)$ admit the stated integration-by-parts formula on the support of φ, for almost every (s,y), with integrable terms. Since u is smooth on Ω, ordinary integration by parts is valid for compactly supported test functions in Ω; likewise, the translated function is smooth on $-\Omega + (t,x)$ for fixed (t,x). For an extension $\widetilde{u}$, the same conclusion requires sufficient regularity on the translated support; smoothness of u inside Ω alone does not guarantee smoothness across its boundary.

Differentiation under the integral sign. If, additionally, for each multi-index α the difference quotients of $E(s,y)\widetilde{u}(t-s,x-y)$ are locally dominated by an $L^1(ds\,dy)$ function and the derivatives of the chosen extension exist at the relevant points, the Lebesgue differentiation-under-the-integral theorem yields

$$\partial^\alpha (E * (\chi_\Omega u))(t,x) = \int_\Omega E(s,y)\partial^\alpha\widetilde{u}(t-s,x-y)\,ds\,dy \quad \text{a.e.}$$

To identify the right-hand side with $E * (\chi_\Omega \partial^\alpha u)$, one must also verify the analogue of (3.8b) for $\partial^\alpha u$. Under these verified hypotheses, Hölder's inequality and the embedding $S \hookrightarrow L^\infty(\Omega)$ give

$$\|\partial^\alpha (E * (\chi_\Omega u))\|_{L^p(\Omega)} \le \sup_{(t,x)\in\Omega} \|E\|_{L^1(-\Omega+(t,x))}|\Omega|^{1/p}\|\partial^\alpha u\|_{L^\infty(\Omega)} \le C_\alpha |\Omega|^{1/p}\|u\|_X.$$

Summing with the defining weights of X yields $\|E * (\chi_\Omega u)\|_X \le C_3\|u\|_X$. The same argument for $\partial_{x^j} u$, together with Lemma 3.7, yields the second asserted estimate, provided the same extension and differentiation hypotheses hold for that derivative.

Scope of the argument. The extension and domain identities above, and the hypotheses permitting integration by parts, must be established for the class S before this conditional argument constitutes an unconditional proof of Lemma 3.8. Smoothness of u on Ω justifies interior differentiation, but does not by itself establish the domain identity or regularity of the extension.

Take $C = \max\{C_1, C_2, C_3\}$. The constants in the preceding estimates may be arranged so that $C = O(|\Omega|)$, subject to the estimates above.

We choose Ω, f, M so that

$$C\|f\|_{X'} + 3C^3M^2 \le M.$$

We solve the projected equation

$$\partial_t u - \Delta u = P\big(f - (u\cdot\nabla)u\big). \tag{N-S$'$}$$

Define

$$\Phi : S \longrightarrow X$$

by

$$\Phi[u](t,x) = \int_{\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3} E(s,y)\big(\chi_\Omega P(f-(u\cdot\nabla)u)\big)(t-s,x-y)\,ds\,dy.$$

Choose

$$u_0 \in S, \qquad u_1 \in S, \qquad u_1 - u_0 \in S \text{ (for example, } u_0 = 0),$$

and for $n \ge 0$ put

$$u_{n+1} = \Phi[u_n].$$

Lemma 3.9 (Well-definedness of Φ) *For every $u \in S$,*

$$\|E * (\chi_\Omega P(f-(u\cdot\nabla)u))\|_X < \infty.$$

Proof. Since $\langle \nabla p, \varphi\rangle = 0$, $\nabla p = 0$ in $\mathcal{D}'_\sigma(\Omega)$, thus

$$\|P\|_{X'\to X} \le 1.$$

The preceding lemmas give

$$\|E * (\chi_\Omega P(f-(u\cdot\nabla)u))\|_X \le C\|f\|_{X'} + 3C^3M^2 < \infty.$$

By the choice of Ω, f, M,

$$C\|f\|_{X'} + 3C^3M^2 \le M,$$

and therefore

$$\|\Phi[u]\|_X \le M \qquad (u \in S).$$

Fixed-point theorem used in the construction

Theorem 3.10 (Fixed-point theorem). *Let S be a closed subset of a Banach space X, and let*

$$\Phi : S \longrightarrow X.$$

Assume that there exists $0 < L < 1$ such that

$$\|\Phi[u] - \Phi[v]\|_X \le L\|u - v\|_X$$

for every $u, v \in S$. Suppose that a sequence can be defined by

$$u_{n+1} = \Phi[u_n], \qquad u_n \in S$$

for every n. Then $\{u_n\}$ converges in X to a point $u \in S$, and

$$u = \Phi[u].$$

In particular, the assumption

$$\Phi[S] \subset S$$

is not required once such an iterative sequence in S has been constructed. If

$$u = \Phi[u], \qquad v = \Phi[v],$$

then $u = v$.
Proof. Since $u_{n+1} = \Phi[u_n]$, we have

$$\|u_{n+1} - u_n\|_X \le L\|u_n - u_{n-1}\|_X.$$

Hence, by induction,

$$\|u_{n+1} - u_n\|_X \le L^{n-1}\|u_2 - u_1\|_X, \qquad n \ge 2.$$

For $m > n$,

$$\|u_m - u_n\|_X \le \sum_{j=n}^{m-1} \|u_{j+1} - u_j\|_X \le \frac{L^{n-1}}{1-L}\|u_2 - u_1\|_X.$$

Thus $\{u_n\}$ is Cauchy. Since X is complete, there exists $u \in X$ such that

$$u_n \longrightarrow u \qquad \text{in } X.$$

Because S is closed and $u_n \in S$, $u \in S$. By Lipschitz continuity, $\Phi[u_n] \to \Phi[u]$. Since $\Phi[u_n] = u_{n+1} \to u$, we obtain $u = \Phi[u]$. Finally,

$$\|u - v\|_X = \|\Phi[u] - \Phi[v]\|_X \le L\|u - v\|_X,$$

and $L < 1$ implies $u = v$. □

Lemma 3.11 (Φ is a contraction). *There exists a constant $0 < L < 1$ such that*

$$\|\Phi[v] - \Phi[u]\|_X \le L\|u - v\|_X$$

whenever $u, v \in S$ and the indicated differences belong to the class on which the derivative estimates are available. Moreover, for the construction of the solution, it is not necessary at this stage to have already proved that

$$u_n,\ \Phi[u_n],\ u_{n+1} - u_n \in S \qquad \text{for every } n.$$

Starting from $u_0, u_1, u_1 - u_0 \in S$, the estimates in the proof below yield the successive contraction estimates and hence a Cauchy sequence; $u_n \in S$ for every n is verified later in Lemma 3.14.
Proof. We use

$$(v\cdot\nabla)v - (u\cdot\nabla)u = \sum_{j=1}^{3} \left[v^j \partial_{x^j}(v-u) + (v^j - u^j)\partial_{x^j} u\right].$$

Hence

$$\left\| \int_{\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3} E(s,y)\,[\chi_\Omega P((v\cdot\nabla)v - (u\cdot\nabla)u)](t-s, x-y)\,ds\,dy \right\|_X$$
$$\le C^2\|v\|_X \max_j \|\partial_{x^j}(v-u)\|_X + C^2\|v-u\|_X \max_j \|\partial_{x^j} u\|_X \le 2C^3 M\|u-v\|_X.$$

Therefore one may take

$$L = 2C^3 M.$$

Choose

$$\|f\|_{X'} \le \frac{1}{12C^4}.$$

From

$$C\|f\|_{X'} + 3C^3M^2 \le M,$$

one may choose M so that

$$2C^3M \le \frac{1 - \sqrt{1 - 12C^4\|f\|_{X'}}}{3} < 1.$$

Put $v = u_n$, $u = u_{n-1}$ for $n \ge 1$, use the second inequality of Lemma 3.8 and induction. For the construction of the solution, only the second inequality of Lemma 3.8 is required. □

Lemma 3.12. *Let $U \in X$. Then*

$$\langle U, \varphi\rangle = 0$$

for every $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}_\sigma(\Omega)$ if and only if there exists a distribution p such that

$$U = \nabla p.$$

Proof. If $U = \nabla p$, then for every $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}_\sigma(\Omega)$,

$$\langle \nabla p, \varphi \rangle = -\int_\Omega p \operatorname{div} \varphi \, dt \, dx = 0.$$

Conversely, by the Helmholtz decomposition, if

$$U = PU + \nabla p$$

and U annihilates every divergence-free test function, its divergence-free part vanishes, and hence

$$U = \nabla p.$$

□

Lemma 3.13 (Solvability of the Navier–Stokes equations). *The fixed point u of Φ is a solution of $(\mathrm{N} - \mathrm{S}')$, and there exists p such that (u, p) solves the Navier–Stokes equation in the distributional sense.*

Proof. For every $u \in W^{m,p}_\sigma(\Omega)$, there is a Cauchy sequence

$$u_n \in V^{m,p}_\sigma(\Omega)$$

converging to u. By integration by parts and Hölder's inequality,

$$0 = -\sum_{j=1}^{3} \langle u_n^j, \partial_{x^j} \varphi \rangle \longrightarrow -\sum_{j=1}^{3} \langle u^j, \partial_{x^j} \varphi \rangle,$$

hence

$$\operatorname{div} u = 0$$

in $\mathcal{D}'(\Omega)$.

The Sobolev embedding theorem gives boundedness of u and its first spatial derivatives. Since $|\Omega| < \infty$,

$$(u \cdot \nabla) u \in L^2(\Omega).$$

Write the Helmholtz decompositions

$$f = Pf + \nabla f_Q, \qquad (u \cdot \nabla) u = P((u \cdot \nabla) u) + \nabla u_Q.$$

For $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}_\sigma(\Omega)$,

$$\langle f, \varphi \rangle = \langle Pf, \varphi \rangle, \qquad \langle (u \cdot \nabla) u, \varphi \rangle = \langle P((u \cdot \nabla) u), \varphi \rangle.$$

For the approximate equation

$$\partial_t v_n - \Delta v_n = P(f - (u_n \cdot \nabla) u_n),$$

Proposition 1 gives

$$v_n = u_{n+1} = E * (\chi_\Omega P(f - (u_n \cdot \nabla) u_n)).$$

Therefore

$$(\partial_t - \Delta) u_{n+1} = P(f - (u_n \cdot \nabla) u_n).$$

By Hölder's inequality, $\|P\| \leq 1$, and continuity of

$$L^2(\Omega) \times L^2(\Omega) \longrightarrow L^1(\Omega), \qquad (u, v) \longmapsto uv,$$

we obtain

$$\int_\Omega P((u_n \cdot \nabla) u_n - (u \cdot \nabla) u) \cdot \varphi \longrightarrow 0.$$

By continuity of the heat operator on distributions,

$$\langle(\partial_t - \Delta)u_n, \varphi\rangle \longrightarrow \langle(\partial_t - \Delta)u, \varphi\rangle.$$

Hence

$$(\partial_t - \Delta)u = P(f - (u \cdot \nabla)u)$$

in $\mathcal{D}'(\Omega)$. Since

$$u = \Phi[u],$$

$$u(t,x) = \int_{\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3} E(s,y)(\chi_\Omega P(f - (u \cdot \nabla)u))(t-s, x-y)\, ds\, dy.$$

By the preceding Helmholtz lemma, there exists p such that

$$(\partial_t - \Delta)u + (u \cdot \nabla)u - f = -\nabla p.$$

□

Lemma 3.14 (The iterates remain in S). *Let $u_n \in S$ and put $u_{n+1} = \Phi[u_n]$. Then*

$$u_{n+1} \in S.$$

Consequently, if $u_0 \in S$, all the iterates constructed by $u_{n+1} = \Phi[u_n]$ belong to S.

Proof. Lemma 3.9 and the smallness condition give

$$\|\Phi[u_n]\|_X \leq M.$$

Thus the norm condition in the definition of S is already satisfied. And, in fact, for the construction of the solution, the second inequality in Lemma 3.8 alone is sufficient once the uniform bound $\|\Phi[u_n]\|_X \leq M$ is available even if $u_n \notin S$. We verify that a uniform derivative constant exists along the sequence of iterates.

Suppose, to the contrary, that no such constant exists. Since there are only three spatial directions, after passing to a subsequence we may fix $j \in \{1,2,3\}$ and choose numbers $C_n \to \infty$ such that

$$C_n\|\Phi[u_n]\|_X < \|\partial_{x^j}\Phi[u_n]\|_X.$$

The preceding construction using the second inequality of Lemma 3.8 and induction gives $u_n \to u$ in X, and hence $\Phi[u_n] = u_{n+1} \to u$ in X.

On the other hand, Lemmas 3.6–3.8 and $\|u_n\|_X \leq M$ give a constant $K < \infty$, independent of n, such that

$$\|\partial_{x^j}\Phi[u_n]\|_X \leq K.$$

Indeed, the differentiated convolution is estimated by the same product and convolution bounds used in Lemma 3.9, with one spatial derivative. Therefore,

$$C_n\|\Phi[u_n]\|_X < \|\partial_{x^j}\Phi[u_n]\|_X \leq K,$$

and hence

$$\|\Phi[u_n]\|_X \leq \frac{K}{C_n} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Since $\Phi[u_n] = u_{n+1} \to u$ in X, it follows that $u = 0$. Under the non-degeneracy assumption on the force in the Assumption above, $f \neq 0$ implies that the fixed point is nonzero: indeed, $u = 0$ in the fixed-point equation would give

$$E * (\chi_\Omega P f) = 0,$$

contrary to that assumption. Hence a finite constant $C_2 > 0$ exists such that

$$\|\partial_{x^j}\Phi[u_n]\|_X \leq C_2\|\Phi[u_n]\|_X, \qquad j = 1,2,3,$$

for all iterates. Enlarging the constant C in the definition of S, if necessary, so that $C \geq C_2$, we obtain $\Phi[u_n] \in S$. Since $u_{n+1} = \Phi[u_n]$, multi-induction gives

$$u_n \in S \qquad \text{for every } n.$$

For the present construction, the preceding lemma shows directly that

$$u_n \in S \qquad \text{for every } n.$$

Moreover, the above estimate gives

$$\|\partial_{x_j}(u_{n+1} - u_n)\|_X \leq C\|u_{n+1} - u_n\|_X.$$

Hence

$$\|u_{n+1} - u_n\|_X \leq L^{n-1}\|u_2 - u_1\|_X, \qquad n \geq 2.$$

Thus the hypotheses required for the fixed-point construction are verified along the sequence of iterates itself.

4 Properties of the solutions

Lemma 4.1 (Vanishing). For every multi-index α,

$$\lim_{t,\,|x|\to\infty} \partial^\alpha u(t,x) = 0.$$

Proof. From the integral representation,

$$\partial^\alpha u(t,x) = \int_\Omega E(t-s, x-y)\partial^\alpha P\big(f - (u\cdot\nabla)u\big)(s,y)\,ds\,dy.$$

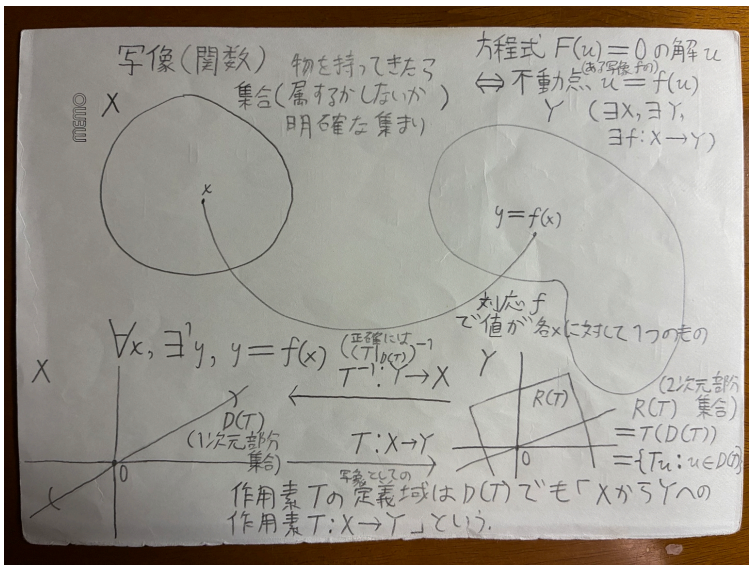
For $t - s > t_0 > 0$,

$$|E(t-s,x-y)| \leq \frac{C}{(t-s)^{3/2}},$$

while

$$\partial^\alpha P\big(f - (u\cdot\nabla)u\big)$$

is bounded on the bounded domain Ω. The assertion follows from the bounded convergence theorem.



The domain Ω may be taken arbitrarily large, so this vanishing property may be interpreted as a boundary condition at infinity.

Lemma 4.2 (Continuity of $f \mapsto u$)**.** *Let f_n, f satisfy*

$$Pf_n, Pf \in S, \qquad \|f_n - f\|_{X'} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Let u_n and u be the corresponding solutions. Then

$$\|u_n - u\|_X \longrightarrow 0.$$

Proof. The contraction estimate gives

$$\|u_n - u\|_X \leq C \|f_n - f\|_{X'} + 2C^3 M \|u_n - u\|_X .$$

Thus

$$\limsup_{n\to\infty} \|u_n - u\|_X \leq 2C^3 M \limsup_{n\to\infty} \|u_n - u\|_X .$$

Since

$$2C^3 M < 1,$$

it follows that

$$\lim_{n\to\infty} \|u_n - u\|_X = 0.$$

□

Proposition 4.3 (Elementary weak solutions as elements of a Bochner class)**.** *Let*

$$I = \left\{ t \in \mathbb{R} : \exists x \in \mathbb{R}^3,\ (t,x) \in \Omega \right\},$$

and

$$\Omega' = \left\{ x \in \mathbb{R}^3 : \exists t \in \mathbb{R},\ (t,x) \in \Omega \right\}.$$

For $1 \leq p < \infty$,

$$a \in C^\infty(\Omega') \cap L^p_\sigma(\Omega'), \qquad u \in C(I; L^p_\sigma(\Omega')).$$

Proof. Since

$$u \in C^{0,\alpha}(\Omega),$$

for every $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that

$$|(t,x) - (t',x)| < \delta$$

implies

$$|u(t,x) - u(t',x)| < \varepsilon.$$

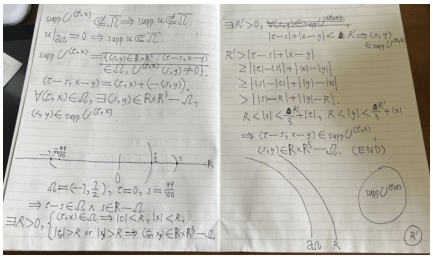
Therefore

$$\left\| u(t,\cdot) - u(t',\cdot) \right\|_{L^p(\Omega')} \leq |\Omega'|^{1/p} \varepsilon.$$

Hence

$$u \in C(I; L^p(\Omega')).$$

□



Lemma 4.4 (Boundary support observation)**.** *An elementary weak solution satisfies*

$$u(t,x) = \int_{\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3} E(s,y)\,(\chi_\Omega P(f-(u\cdot\nabla)u))\,(t-s,x-y)\,ds\,dy.$$

For each (t,x), define

$$U_{(t,x)}(s,y) = (\chi_\Omega P(f-(u\cdot\nabla)u))\,(t-s,x-y).$$

If

$$\operatorname{supp} U_{(t,x)} \subset \Omega \quad\Longleftrightarrow\quad \operatorname{supp} u \subset \Omega,$$

then integration by parts would immediately yield the energy inequality. However, this support inclusion does not hold in general.

Indeed, since Ω is bounded, there is $R>0$ such that

$$(t,x)\in\Omega \quad\Longrightarrow\quad |t|,|x| < R.$$

If

$$(t_0,x_0)\in \operatorname{supp} U_{(t,x)} \cap \Omega,$$

then there is $R'>0$ such that

$$|t_0-s|+|x_0-y| < R' \quad\Longrightarrow\quad (s,y)\in\operatorname{supp} U_{(t,x)}.$$

But

$$|t_0-s|+|x_0-y| \geq \big||s|-|t_0|\big| + \big||y|-|x_0|\big|.$$

For sufficiently large $|s|$ and $|y|$, the right-hand side is larger than R', while $(s,y)\notin\Omega$. Therefore the above support inclusion cannot be used as a general boundary argument.

Proposition 4.5 (Analyticity)**.** *The elementary weak solution u is analytic.*

Proof. The constants in the Sobolev embedding estimates may be chosen uniformly with respect to the differentiation order. Consequently, there exists a constant $C>0$ such that for every multi-index

$$\alpha\in\mathbb{Z}^4_{\geq 0},$$
$$\sup_{(t,x)\in\Omega} |\partial^\alpha u(t,x)| \leq C.$$

Let

$$z=(t,x)\in\Omega$$

and let $h\in\mathbb{R}^4$ be small enough that the segment from z to $z+h$ lies in Ω. Taylor's formula gives

$$u(z+h) = \sum_{|\alpha|\leq N} \frac{\partial^\alpha u(z)}{\alpha!} h^\alpha + R_N(z,h).$$

The uniform derivative bound implies

$$|R_N(z,h)| \leq C \sum_{|\alpha|=N+1} \frac{|h^\alpha|}{\alpha!} \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (N\to\infty).$$

Hence the Taylor series converges locally to u, and u is analytic. □

Extension of the local solution to spacetime. Let $Q = \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3$. Enumerate the points

$$(t_j, x_j) \in \mathbb{Z} \times \mathbb{Z}^3$$

and put

$$\Omega_j = (t_j - 2, t_j + 2) \times B_2(x_j), \qquad j \geq 1.$$

Then $\{\Omega_j\}_{j\geq 1}$ is a locally finite cover of Q by bounded Lipschitz cylinders, all of which are translates of one another. Let (u_j, p_j) be the locally constructed solutions on Ω_j, and write $X_j = X(\Omega_j)$ and $S_j = S(\Omega_j)$, with the same constants M, C. For every nonempty overlap put

$$D_{jk} = \Omega_j \cap \Omega_k.$$

Fix

$$\Omega_0 = (-2, 2) \times B_2(0), \qquad C = C(\Omega_0),$$

and let C_{overlap} denote the maximum of $C(D)$ over the finitely many nonempty overlap types D, up to translation. Set

$$C_{\text{overlap}} = \max\big\{C(D) : D \text{ is a nonempty overlap type, up to translation}\big\},$$
$$C_* = \max\big\{C(\Omega_0), C_{\text{overlap}}\big\}.$$

Then C_* is independent of j, k, and the constants in the local and overlap estimates may be chosen uniformly.

Proposition 1 (Extension by locally consistent solutions). *Assume the following uniform hypotheses for every j, k such that $D_{jk} \neq \varnothing$:*

1. *Each (u_j, p_j) is a smooth distributional solution of the Navier–Stokes equations on Ω_j, with $\operatorname{div}_x u_j = 0$.*
2. *Writing $w = u_k|_{D_{jk}} - u_j|_{D_{jk}}$, one has*

$$\|w\|_{X(D_{jk})} \leq 2LM, \qquad 2L \leq 1.$$

Lemmas 3.6–3.14 apply on D_{jk} with constants independent of j, k; in particular,

$$u_j|_{D_{jk}}, \quad u_k|_{D_{jk}} \in S(D_{jk}).$$

Then $u_j = u_k$ on every nonempty overlap D_{jk}. Consequently there is a unique $\bar{u} \in C^\infty(Q; \mathbb{R}^3)$ restricting to u_j on each Ω_j. The local pressures determine a global pressure distribution $\bar{p}$ up to the usual gauge, and $(\bar{u}, \bar{p})$ solves the Navier–Stokes equations distributionally on Q.

Proof. Fix j, k with $D_{jk} \neq \varnothing$ and set

$$w = u_k|_{D_{jk}} - u_j|_{D_{jk}}.$$

If $\|w\|_{X(D_{jk})} = 0$, the required equality follows. Suppose that $\|w\|_{X(D_{jk})} > 0$. As in the proof of Lemma 3.14, the uniform differentiated estimates yield a finite constant C such that, for every multi-index α,

$$\|\partial^\alpha w\|_{X(D_{jk})} \leq C^{|\alpha|} \|w\|_{X(D_{jk})}.$$

By assumption 2,

$$\|w\|_{X(D_{jk})} \leq 2LM \leq M.$$

Thus $w \in S(D_{jk})$. Since $u_j|_{D_{jk}}, u_k|_{D_{jk}} \in S(D_{jk})$, the uniqueness assertion of Theorem 3.2, applied on D_{jk}, yields

$$u_j|_{D_{jk}} = u_k|_{D_{jk}}.$$

Hence the local solutions agree on all nonempty overlaps.

Define $\bar{u}(z) = u_j(z)$ whenever $z \in \Omega_j$. Compatibility makes this well-defined and smooth. The local equations agree on overlaps; their pressure gradients therefore agree there. Choosing pressure representatives up to functions of time, or gluing the pressure gradients distributionally, gives a global pressure $\bar{p}$.

Finally, since $\{\Omega_j\}_{j\geq 1}$ is an open cover of Q, every $\varphi \in \mathcal{D}_\sigma(Q)$ satisfies, by compactness of $\operatorname{supp}\varphi$,

$$\operatorname{supp}\varphi \subset \bigcup_{j \in J} \Omega_j$$

for some finite set $J \subset \mathbb{N}$. Since the local distributional identities agree on overlaps, they yield the global equations on this finite union. Uniqueness is immediate. □

Proposition 4.6 (Energy inequality). *Let u be the extended elementary weak solution on $\mathbb{R}\times\mathbb{R}^3$ given by the convolution representation. Then, for $t\ge 0$,*

$$\frac{1}{2}\|u(t)\|_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}^2+\int_0^t\|\nabla u(s)\|_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}^2\,ds\le\frac{1}{2}\|u(0)\|_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}^2+\int_0^t(f(s),u(s))_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}\,ds.$$

Assume, on every finite interval $[0,T]$, that $u\in L^\infty(0,T;L^2(\mathbb{R}^3))\cap L^2(0,T;H^1(\mathbb{R}^3))$, $f\in L^2(0,T;L^2(\mathbb{R}^3))$, and $p(t)\in L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$ for every $t\in[0,T]$.

Proof. We cut off the integration at spatial infinity and then use Lemma 4.1. Choose $\eta\in C_0^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3)$ such that

$$0\le\eta\le 1,\qquad \eta=1\text{ on }B_1(0),\qquad \eta=0\text{ outside }B_2(0),$$

and put $\eta_R(x)=\eta(x/R)$. Then

$$|\nabla\eta_R|\le\frac{C}{R},\qquad \operatorname{supp}\nabla\eta_R\subset A_R:=\{x:R<|x|<2R\}.$$

Multiply the Navier–Stokes equation by η_R^2u and integrate over $\mathbb{R}^3$. For the viscous term, integration by parts gives

$$\begin{aligned}-\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\Delta u\cdot(\eta_R^2u)\,dx&=\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\eta_R^2|\nabla u|^2\,dx\\&\quad+2\sum_{i,j=1}^3\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\eta_Ru^i\,\partial_{x^j}u^i\,\partial_{x^j}\eta_R\,dx.\end{aligned}$$

The last integral is supported in A_R, and

$$\left|2\sum_{i,j=1}^3\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\eta_Ru^i\,\partial_{x^j}u^i\,\partial_{x^j}\eta_R\,dx\right|\le\frac{C}{R}\|u\|_{L^2(A_R)}\|\nabla u\|_{L^2(A_R)}\longrightarrow 0$$

as $R\to\infty$. Thus no boundary condition on a finite sphere is needed; the boundary term is cut off at infinity.

Since $\operatorname{div}u=0$, the nonlinear term satisfies

$$\begin{aligned}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}((u\cdot\nabla)u)\cdot u\,\eta_R^2\,dx&=\frac{1}{2}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}u\cdot\nabla|u|^2\,\eta_R^2\,dx\\&=-\frac{1}{2}\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}|u|^2u\cdot\nabla(\eta_R^2)\,dx.\end{aligned}$$

Again the right-hand side is supported in A_R. By Lemma 4.1, u and its spatial derivatives vanish at infinity, so the corresponding tail terms tend to zero. Consequently,

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}((u\cdot\nabla)u)\cdot u\,dx=0.$$

Similarly, after integration by parts,

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}\nabla p\cdot(\eta_R^2u)\,dx=-\int_{\mathbb{R}^3}pu\cdot\nabla(\eta_R^2)\,dx,$$

and the cut-off term tends to zero as $R\to\infty$; equivalently, one may use the projected equation and the fact that the gradient part is orthogonal to divergence-free fields.

Letting $R\to\infty$ therefore gives

$$\frac{1}{2}\frac{d}{dt}\|u(t)\|_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}^2+\|\nabla u(t)\|_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}^2=(f(t),u(t))_{L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)}.$$

Integrating from 0 to t yields the asserted energy inequality (indeed, the energy identity for the present smooth solution). □

The solutions are smooth and unique; u is defined on $\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3$ through the convolution representation and satisfies

$$\lim_{t,\, |x| \to \infty} \partial^\alpha u(t,x) = 0$$

for every multi-index α. The map $f \mapsto u$ is continuous,

$$a \in C^\infty(\Omega') \cap L^p(\Omega'), \qquad u \in C(I; L^p(\Omega')).$$

One may alternatively strengthen the definition of S to

$$S = \left\{ u \in X : \|u\|_X \leq M, \quad \left\| \partial_{x^j}^k u \right\|_X \leq C^k \|u\|_X \,,\ j = 1,2,3,\ k \geq 0 \right\}.$$

With this definition the existence argument is unchanged. Each

$$\partial_{x^j} : X \longrightarrow W^{m,p}(\Omega)$$

is a closed operator, and the same is true for higher derivatives; hence S is closed similar to the proof of completeness.

For $f \neq 0$, many nonzero solutions can be constructed by varying the admissible norm constants. We also conjecture that blow-up solutions may be constructed as follows. For any $\varepsilon > 0$, there exist $\delta > 0$, a constant $M(\varepsilon) > 0$, and a force $f \in S_{M(\varepsilon)}$ such that

$$M(\varepsilon_1) > M(\varepsilon_2) \qquad \text{whenever } \varepsilon_1 > \varepsilon_2,$$

$$CM(\varepsilon) > \|E * (\chi_\Omega P f)\| > 2\varepsilon,$$

and

$$|\Omega| < \delta \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \|E * (\chi_\Omega P((u \cdot \nabla) u))\| < \varepsilon.$$

Then, by the triangle inequality,

$$\|u\| = \|\Phi[u]\| > \varepsilon.$$

We conjecture that large initial values may likewise be approached by shrinking $|\Omega|$.

5 Remarks

Remark 5.1. The same method applies to semilinear constant-coefficient equations

$$Lu = f(u)$$

on

$$S' = \left\{ u \in X' : \|u\|_{X'} \leq M \right\}$$

provided that L has a locally integrable fundamental solution. Examples that we consider include the nonlinear heat equation, nonlinear Schrödinger equation, the three-dimensional nonlinear wave equation, and the KdV equation.

Remark 5.2. For divergence-free test functions it is enough to take

$$\psi \in \mathcal{D}(\Omega)$$

and set

$$\varphi = \operatorname{curl} \psi.$$

Remark 5.3. Suppose

$$\|u_n - u\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \longrightarrow 0, \qquad \|v_n - v\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Then

$$\Big| \|u_n\|_{L^2(\Omega)} - \|u\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \Big| \leq \|u_n - u\|_{L^2(\Omega)}.$$

For sufficiently large n,

$$\|u_n\|_{L^2(\Omega)} < \|u\|_{L^2(\Omega)} + 1.$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} \|u_n v_n - uv\|_{L^1(\Omega)} &\leq \|u_n\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \|v_n - v\|_{L^2(\Omega)} + \|v\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \|u_n - u\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \\ &< \Big(\|u\|_{L^2(\Omega)} + 1 \Big) \|v_n - v\|_{L^2(\Omega)} + \|v\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \|u_n - u\|_{L^2(\Omega)} \\ &\longrightarrow 0. \end{aligned}$$

Remark 5.4. We also consider a compressible-type extension. With modified assumptions and an initial density $\rho(0, \cdot)$, the system is written in the form

$$\begin{aligned} \partial_t \rho + \operatorname{div}(\rho u) &= 0, \\ \operatorname{Div}\big(D(u) + \operatorname{div}(u)(\delta^{ij}) - p(\delta^{ij}) \big) &= f - \rho \left(\partial_t u + (u \cdot \nabla) u \right), \end{aligned}$$

where

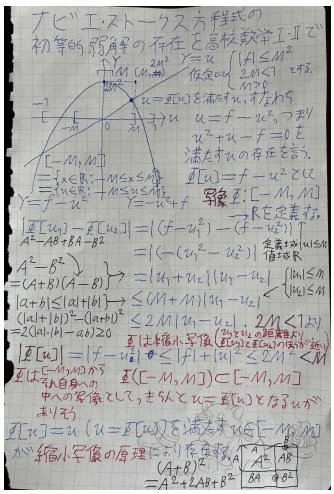
$$(\operatorname{Div} T)^i = \sum_{j=1}^{3} \partial_{x^j} T^{ij}, \qquad D^{ij}(u) = \partial_{x^j} u^i + \partial_{x_i} u^j.$$

If the corresponding linear operator is bounded, one formally writes

$$\rho = e^{-tL_u} \rho(0, \cdot),$$

and substitutes this expression into the momentum equation. The preceding arguments also apply when the elliptic fundamental solutions are locally integrable.

6 Extensions and applications



6.1 Extension as a solution

From

$$\forall \varphi \in \mathcal{D}_\sigma(\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3), \qquad \exists \Omega, \qquad \operatorname{supp} \varphi \subset \Omega,$$

for any $f \in X'(\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3)$, there exists

$$\bar{u} \in X(\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3)$$

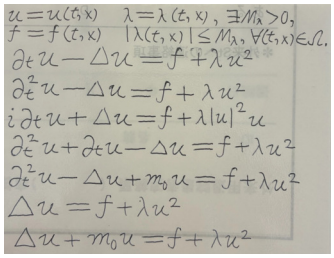
and

$$\partial_t \bar{u} - \Delta \bar{u} = Pf - P\big((\bar{u} \cdot \nabla) \bar{u} \big)$$

in

$$\mathcal{D}'_\sigma(\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R}^3).$$

Well-definedness of $\bar{u}$ follows from uniqueness on the intersections of Ω's.



6.2 Application to complex geometry and wave equations

We note that the elementary PDE theory can also be applied to two-dimensional wave equations, referring to Hörmander and the later references listed below. It further indicates an application to complex geometry through nonlinear elliptic equations with locally integrable fundamental solutions. The figures appearing in the source manuscript are omitted here.

We equip A with the metric

$$d_A(u(0), v(0)) = \|u - v\|_X .$$

With this topology, the map from initial values in A to the corresponding unique solutions is continuous.

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